of Europe.

Ravaged by Nazism and Fascism, Eastern Europe, finally liberated, did not enjoy its freedom long. In fact, within a few months or, at most, a couple of years of liberation from Nazism and Fascism, the region was forced into a new totalitarian system. In most countries, the shell of the national state remained (except in the Baltic countries which were annexed by the Soviet Union) but it was empty of freedom again. Soviet-style Communism spread all over Eastern Europe, the Iron Curtain was drawn, contacts with the West were cut and the region sank into oblivion. Members of various anti-Communist movements went into exile. Many were not lucky enough to escape and became victims of mass purges. Both the exile and the purges significantly altered the political and social landscape for generations – the situation amounted to a policide. Central and Eastern Europe was abandoned and left at the mercy of the new rulers and their Soviet mentors. And in the eyes of Western Europeans, the region was labelled once again an alien, inhospitable, almost non-European place. It would remain so until the late 1980s.[74]

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38. SA Mansbach in *New Frontiers – Art from New EU Member States*, National Gallery of Ireland, 2004. Mansbach certainly has a point, and the poem to Napoleon and later his statue are good examples. But art *was* used for nationalist/political purposes in many of the Western countries too, though at different points in time. If nothing else, nation building was there forged through war memorials and statesmen's statues, above all after the two world wars. Alain De Botton (in *Art as Therapy*, Phaidon, 2015, p. 201 – 208) points to the wider concept of 'political art', for example, works by Anselm Kiefer, trying to address the 'appalling tragedy of Germany in the late 1930s and early 1940s' or the wrapping of the Reichstag (the German Federal parliament in Berlin) by Christo and Jeanne-Claude in 1995. And in 1955 Nikolaus Pevsner found Englishness in 'chairs, bookshelves and door-handles'.

39. Wandycz, pp. 180–200.

40. The right of nations for self-determination again resurfaced at the time of the break-up of Yugoslavia – another occasion when the Continent was unable to solve its own affairs and US involvement was needed – and then again with the issue of Kosovo. Do the people of Kosovo possess this right? The answer given by the International Court of Justice in The Hague was not straightforward. The Court merely stated that 'the declaration of independence of Kosovo, adopted on 17 February 2008 did not violate international law'. Indeed, many believe that it is not possible to give a straightforward answer because there seems to be no legal definition of what exactly constitutes a 'people', and the principle of self-determination is in conflict today with another principle of the inviolability of the territorial integrity of states. Interestingly enough, as many as 36 countries from across the globe sent their submissions to that question to the ICJ in the spring of 2009. The UK, in the case of Scotland, and Spain, in the case of Catalonia, approach this issue from different angles.